

The startup designs and develops all products in-house while leveraging EMS facilities for large-scale manufacturing. The first 100 units of any product are produced internally to ensure thorough testing and quality assurance before transitioning to mass production at EMS houses.

Their in-house innovation centre has advanced tooling for mechanical shaping and forming, electronic soldering stations with stencils for precise solder paste application, and assembly lines for box building. The R&D facility also includes extensive testing capabilities, such as waveform analysers, load banks for resistance and load testing, and communication disruptors to evaluate performance under communication disturbances. With controlled temperature and dustproof environments, the centre upholds stringent standards across all product development and testing stages.

The startup has experienced rapid growth in the sales of charging

stations. “We have over 40,000 chargers, with the majority of them at homes followed by e-commerce fleets. This year, sales have grown tenfold and have shown a significant increase in monthly sales from around 1000 in January to 9000 in October. Over the last eight to nine months, the scale-up has been remarkable, showcasing the incredible expansion in this market,” concludes Akshay.

The company is focused on collaborating with multiple partners, including EMS houses, across various geographies to ensure operational flexibility and resilience. It is also actively seeking partnerships with microprocessor and PCB manufacturers to enable local production, which remains a top priority. Additionally, the company is exploring partnerships with installation experts with the technical expertise to set up charging stations and efficiently manage earthing requirements. Furthermore, it is keen on



Akshay Shekhar, Co-Founder and CEO, Kazam

identifying innovative earthing solutions that can reduce costs and installation time, enhancing overall operational efficiency.

The company achieved 4x growth in the last fiscal year, equivalent to 400%. It is on track to replicate 100% of that growth from the previous year this year. Over the next two years, Kazam aims to triple its revenue, building on its current growth trajectory.

2 MARUT DRONE-POWERED SOLUTIONS FOR AGRICULTURAL INTELLIGENCE AND AUTOMATION

Founded in Telangana in 2019 by CEO Prem Kumar Vislawath with co-founders Sai Kumar and Suraj Peddi, Marut Drones leverages drone technology to tackle agricultural challenges and promote sustainable farming across India.

All founders are from the 2008 cohort at IIT Guwahati. “After completing our bachelor’s degrees, we gained experience working in the corporate sector. In 2018, we came together with a shared vision to tackle challenges using drone technology, and by 2019, we officially established the company,” shares Prem.

The company operates through three core verticals. In drone manufacturing, it designs and

builds drones, with over 600 units operating across India. The drone-as-a-service vertical offers customised drone-based solutions to government agencies, corporations, and individual farmers. The drone training division also provides DGCA-approved pilot training and licences, valid for 10 years. Over the past six years, the company has expanded its presence to 14 states, offering a diverse product range that includes spraying drones,

surveillance drones, afforestation drones, and delivery drones, catering to the evolving needs of various sectors.

Marut Drones’ technology focuses on early detection of crop diseases and precision farming, enhancing farm productivity, promoting environmental sustainability, and boosting farmers’ incomes.

While explaining the meaning behind the company’s name, Prem highlights that the choice of